OGSM : FCC-682-2023/013-00
COUNTRY: MAURITANIA

COOPERATIVE AGREEMENT BETWEEN THE GOVERNMENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA AND PARTNERS OF THE AMERICAS FOR THE PROVISION OF AGRICULTURAL COMMODITIES THROUGH THE FOOD FOR PROGRESS ACT

Preamble

The Government of the United States of America, acting through the Commodity Credit Corporation (hereafter referred to as CCC), an agency within the United States Department of Agriculture (hereafter referred to as USDA), and Partners of the Americas (hereafter referred to as the Recipient);

In an effort to use the food resources of the United States in support of countries that have made commitments to introduce or expand free enterprise elements in their agricultural economies through changes in commodity prices, marketing, input availability, distribution, and private sector involvement;

Desiring to set forth the understandings that will govern the provision of agricultural commodities to the Recipient for use in Mauritania under the Food for Progress Program, which is authorized by the Food for Progress Act of 1985, as amended;

Agree as follows:

PART I
TERMS OF DONATION

A. CCC agrees to donate to the Recipient the agricultural commodities, and quantities thereof, specified in Paragraph C (hereinafter referred to as the "donated commodities") for assistance in Mauritania and, to the extent specifically included in Part II, Items I and III, pay ocean transportation and other costs associated with providing the donated commodities. This donation is not for research and development.

B. The Recipient agrees to use the donated commodities, and any amount specified in Part II, Item III, Paragraph A, only in accordance with this agreement and the approved Plan of Operation, Attachment A, which is attached hereto and made a part of this agreement.

C. The donated commodities to be made available under this agreement are as follows:

List of Standard Commodities

Commodity	Maximum Quantity Metric Tons (MT)	Commodity Usage	Packaging	Estimated Arrival At U.S. Port(s)
Hard Red Winter Wheat	60,000	Monetization	Bulk	04/01/2024
Total	**60,000**			

The donated commodities will be in accordance with the Commodity Specifications, Attachment B, which is attached hereto and made a part of this agreement. CCC may, at its option, substitute packaging of a different size or type or both. CCC may, but is not required to, provide extra bags for donated commodities that are packaged if the Recipient requests them at the time that it submits its order for delivery of such donated commodities.

D. CCC will endeavor to provide to the Recipient the maximum quantity of each of the donated commodities specified above. CCC may, however, provide a quantity of a commodity that is less than the maximum quantity, to the extent that in CCC's estimation the total cost of commodities, transportation, and any assistance provided by CCC under this agreement would otherwise exceed $35,550,000.00. For CCC's financial management purposes, costs associated with this agreement will be obligated against budget fiscal year 2023 funds.

E. The Recipient will provide a cost sharing or matching contribution of $600,000.00, resulting in a total Federal award amount of $36,150,000.00.

F. This agreement is subject to the availability, during each fiscal year to which this agreement applies, of the necessary commodities and funds.

G. This agreement is subject to the terms and conditions set forth in 7 CFR part 1499. The Office of Management and Budget guidance at 2 CFR part 200, as supplemented by 2 CFR part 400 and 7 CFR part 1499, applies to the Food for Progress Program. In addition, the following apply to the Food for Progress Program: (1) other regulations that are generally applicable to grants and cooperative agreements of USDA, including 2 CFR parts 25, 170, 175, 180, 182, 415, 417, 418, 421, and 422, to the extent that such regulations do not directly conflict with the provisions of 7 CFR part 1499; and (2) the provisions of the CCC Charter Act (15 U.S.C. 714 *et seq*.) and any other statutory or regulatory provisions that are generally applicable to CCC.

H. The Assistance Listing Number and program title for the Food for Progress Program is 10.606, Food for Progress.

I. The Recipient will, in accordance with a schedule provided to it by CCC, submit to CCC, subject to modification and approval by CCC, Performance Indicators and a Project-level Results Framework. After the parties have agreed to the terms of the Performance Indicators and the Project-level Results Framework, the parties will amend this agreement to include such documents as attachments. The parties will make all reasonable efforts to sign this amendment no later than December 15, 2023. CCC may suspend the provision of donated commodities, funding, or both under this agreement if it determines that the Recipient has not made a reasonable effort to submit Performance Indicators and a Project-level Results Framework in accordance with the schedule for submission provided to it by CCC.

PART II
TRANSPORTATION, DAMAGE OR LOSS, AND PAYMENT OF COSTS

Item I – Transportation of Donated Commodities

A. The Recipient will arrange for the transportation of the donated commodities from the place at which the ocean carrier receives the donated commodities from the commodity supplier to the designated discharge port(s), in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.7(b)(2).

B. The Recipient agrees to arrange for ocean transportation in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.7(a) and 48 CFR part 47, subpart 47.5 – Ocean Transportation by U.S.-Flag Vessels.

C. The Recipient will submit any proposed invitation for transportation bids to CCC and obtain the approval of CCC prior to issuing such invitation. The Recipient will submit any bid that it proposes to accept to CCC and obtain the approval of CCC prior to entering into a contract for transportation based upon such bid. The Recipient will provide to CCC a copy of each contract for transportation. CCC will pay the costs, consistent with the terms of the applicable contract, of transporting the donated commodities from the place at which the ocean carrier receives the donated commodities from the commodity supplier to the designated discharge port(s) by reimbursing the ocean carrier for such costs.

D. The Recipient will include payment instructions in each contract for transportation. The Recipient will require that each request for payment under a contract for transportation of donated commodities be sent to the automated payment system of the Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS) via the web-based supply chain management (WBSCM) system. The Recipient will also ensure that the documents specified in 7 CFR section 1499.6(a)(1) - (6) are maintained on file and made available to CCC.

E. If the Recipient uses the services of a freight forwarder, the Recipient will provide to the Senior Director, International Food Assistance Division (IFAD), FAS, the name of and contact information for the freight forwarder and the certification required by 7 CFR section 1499.7(e) prior to submitting its initial order for the delivery of donated commodities under this agreement.

Item II – Damage to or Loss of Donated Commodities

A. CCC will transfer the title to, and the risk of loss of, the donated commodities to the Recipient at the time and place at which the ocean carrier receives the donated commodities from the commodity supplier.

B. The Recipient will report damage to or loss of donated commodities to which it has title as follows:

(1) If the amount of the damage or loss is estimated to exceed $20,000, the Recipient will notify the Senior Director, IFAD, in writing immediately after becoming aware of such damage or loss, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.9(b)(1)(i);

(2) If the amount of the damage or loss is estimated to exceed $1,000 but not to exceed $20,000, the Recipient will notify the Senior Director, IFAD, in writing within 15 days after the date that the Recipient becomes aware of such damage or loss, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.9(b)(1)(ii); and

(3) If the amount of the damage or loss is estimated not to exceed $1,000, the Recipient will notify CCC in the first report required to be filed under 7 CFR section 1499.13(c) that is due after the date that the Recipient becomes aware of such damage or loss, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.9(b)(1)(iii).

The Recipient will take all steps necessary to protect its interests and the interests of CCC with respect to any damage to or loss of the donated commodities that occurs while the Recipient has title to the donated commodities.

C. In accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.9(c), the Recipient will be responsible for arranging for an independent cargo surveyor to inspect the donated commodities upon discharge from the ocean carrier and to prepare a survey or outturn report. When donated commodities are shipped on a through bill of lading, the Recipient must also obtain a delivery survey. The Recipient will provide a copy of discharge and delivery survey reports to CCC upon request. CCC will reimburse the Recipient for the reasonable costs of these services, as determined by CCC.

D. (1) Paragraph C, 7 CFR section 1499.9(c) - (h), and 7 CFR section 1499.10 will not apply with respect to any donated commodities if the Recipient notifies CCC, prior to the receipt of the donated commodities by the ocean carrier, that the Recipient has sold the donated commodities in accordance with this agreement on terms that require full payment based upon bill of lading quantities.

(2) Paragraph C and 7 CFR section 1499.9(c) - (d) will not apply with respect to any donated commodities if the Recipient notifies CCC, prior to the receipt of the donated commodities by the ocean carrier, that the Recipient has purchased insurance against marine cargo loss and damage (including general average losses) for at least the value of the commodity acquisition, transportation, and related costs incurred by CCC with respect to such donated commodities, as well as such costs incurred by the Recipient and obligated to be paid by CCC under this agreement.

Item III – Payment of Other Costs

A. CCC will provide to the Recipient, through advance payments, not more than $1,400,000.00 to provide assistance in the administration and monitoring of food assistance programs undertaken by the Recipient.

B. (1) The budget approved by CCC for this agreement consists of the Budget Summary, Attachment C-1, and the Budget Narrative, Attachment C-2, which are attached hereto and made a part of this agreement. The Recipient will expend any funds generated from a sale of the donated commodities that is otherwise permitted under this agreement (hereinafter referred to as the "sale proceeds"), funds provided in dollars by CCC, and funds provided as voluntary committed cost sharing or matching contributions, only for costs as specified in the line items in Attachment C-1. The Recipient may expend such funds only up to the amounts specified in the line items in Attachment C-1; except that, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.11(h), the Recipient may make adjustments between direct cost line items in Attachment C-1 without further approval, subject to the limitation in 7 CFR section 1499.11 (h)(2), provided that: (a) the total amount of such adjustments does not exceed ten percent of the Grand Total Costs, excluding any voluntary committed cost sharing or matching contributions, in Attachment C-1, and (b) regardless of the total amount of adjustments, the Recipient must obtain prior approval from CCC for any adjustments that involve actions that require prior approval pursuant to 2 CFR part 200.

(2) Both Attachment C-1 and Attachment C-2 must be amended if the Recipient seeks to make adjustments between direct cost line items greater than ten percent of the Grand Total Costs, excluding any voluntary committed cost sharing or matching contributions, in Attachment C-1. In Attachment C-2, as amended, the sections corresponding to the adjusted line items will show the adjusted line item totals and any changes in amounts within the sections that contributed to the adjusted line item totals, as well as include any changes in the narrative that are required to make it consistent with the adjusted line item totals.

C. (1) Any amounts specified for indirect costs in Attachment C are based upon a provisional rate contained in a Negotiated Indirect Cost Rate Agreement (NICRA). In the event that the final NICRA rate for a particular period is lower than the provisional rate, the Recipient: (a) in the case where CCC has made a payment in dollars for indirect costs, will return the difference to CCC; and (b) in the case where sale proceeds will be used to pay indirect costs, will retain the difference and use it for one or more direct costs identified in Attachment C-1. In the event that the final NICRA rate for a particular period is higher than the provisional rate, the Recipient may request CCC to amend this agreement to permit the Recipient to shift an amount of funds provided by CCC or sale proceeds equal to or less than the difference from direct costs to one or more indirect costs identified in Attachment C-1. In evaluating a request for such an amendment, CCC will consider the effect that the amendment may have on the successful implementation of this agreement. CCC will not enter into such an amendment if it will cause CCC's total costs under this agreement to exceed the dollar amount specified in Part I, Paragraph D.

(2) The Recipient must make all reasonable efforts to obtain its final NICRA rate from the Federal agency responsible for negotiating the rate with the Recipient (hereinafter referred to as the "cognizant Federal agency") prior to the completion of the closeout of this agreement. If the final NICRA rate is not available when the last of the financial and performance reports required by this agreement is due, the Recipient must submit the following information in writing to CCC: (a) a statement that the final NICRA rate is unavailable, (b) the name of, and a point of contact at, the cognizant Federal agency, and (c) the status of the Recipient's final NICRA rate determination, including a timeline for the submission of its proposed final NICRA rate to the cognizant Federal agency and the completion of the final annual single audit or program-specific audit required by 2 CFR part 200, subpart F.

(3) The Recipient must notify CCC immediately, in writing, if the Recipient receives the final NICRA rate prior to the completion of the closeout of this agreement. If the Recipient has already submitted its final financial report to CCC, the Recipient will have 30 days from the date of its notification to CCC of the final NICRA rate to submit a revised final financial report that is based on the final NICRA rate; provided, however, that if CCC does not receive this revised final financial report within one year after the end date of the period of

performance, CCC will complete the closeout of this agreement based on the approved provisional rate and will not authorize any further payments.

D. (1) Except as otherwise provided in this agreement or agreed in writing between the parties, CCC will pay all costs for which it is obligated under this agreement to the Recipient through advance payments.

(2) In accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.6(f)(3), the Recipient must fully disburse funds from the preceding advance before it submits a new advance request under this agreement, with the exception that the Recipient may request to retain the balance of any funds that have not been disbursed and roll it over into a new advance request if the new advance request is made within 90 days after the preceding advance was made.

E. The restrictions in 2 CFR part 200, subpart E, will apply to travel funded, in whole or in part, under this agreement or a subrecipient agreement.

F. Unless CCC authorizes an extension, the Recipient must liquidate all obligations incurred under this agreement and submit its final financial report no later than 120 days after the end date of the period of performance of this agreement specified in Part IV, Paragraph B. The Recipient must refund to CCC any funds provided in dollars by CCC or sale proceeds that it has not expended by the time that it submits its final financial report to CCC under this agreement.

PART III
RECIPIENT'S RESPONSIBILITIES

Item I – General

A. The Recipient will distribute or, if approved by CCC, sell the donated commodities provided under this agreement within Mauritania at the earliest practicable time, in accordance with the terms of this agreement. The Recipient will not sell or transship the donated commodities to any location outside of Mauritania, or use the donated commodities for other than domestic purposes, for as long as the Recipient has title to such donated commodities.

B. The Recipient will not sell or barter the donated commodities except as may be specified in Attachment A or otherwise specifically agreed in writing by CCC, or to dispose of damaged donated commodities in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.9(f).

C. If CCC has approved the sale of some or all of the donated commodities, the Recipient will submit a monetization plan for CCC approval that will include a draft invitation(s) for bids, payment terms, and estimates of reasonable market prices. CCC will not deliver commodities to be monetized to the Recipient until CCC approves the monetization plan and proposed sale price(s) and the Recipient notifies CCC, in writing, that the Recipient has entered into a contract with a buyer for the sale of such commodities. The Recipient will immediately deposit the sale proceeds into an account of a bank in sound financial condition. The account will be insured and interest-bearing, unless CCC agrees in writing that an exception provided for in 7 CFR section 1499.11(g) applies. An appropriate official of the Recipient will supervise such account and must approve all disbursements from the account. The Recipient will maintain a full accounting of all funds under this agreement.

D. As provided in 7 CFR section 1499.11(e), the Recipient will not use any sale proceeds, CCC- provided funds, interest, or program income to acquire goods or services, either directly or indirectly through another party, in a way that violates any of the U.S. Government economic sanctions programs published by the U.S. Treasury Office of Foreign Assets Control at the following website: http://www.treasury.gov/resource-center/sanctions/Pages/default.aspx.

Item II – Reports and Document Submission

A. The Recipient will, within 30 days after both parties have signed this agreement, submit to CCC for approval an organizational chart identifying the names, positions, and responsibilities of all of the Recipient's key personnel. For the purposes of this agreement, the Recipient's key personnel will be managers with general responsibilities for implementation of the agreement, such as the country director, finance director, and chief of party, as well as critical technical staff for specific activities under the agreement. Following approval by CCC of the organizational chart, the Recipient will be required to obtain written approval from CCC before hiring any new key person and notify CCC within one week after the departure of any key person. Furthermore, in accordance with 2 CFR section 200.308(c)(3), the Recipient must obtain written approval from CCC prior to the disengagement from the project for more than three months, or a 25 percent reduction in time devoted to the project, by the approved project director.

B. The Recipient will, within 30 days after the export of all or a portion of the donated commodities, submit evidence of such export to CCC, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.13(e).

C. The Recipient will, within 60 days after both parties have signed this agreement, submit to CCC for approval its work plan. This work plan will include a detailed description of each activity, including estimated start and completion dates for each activity and other information specified by CCC. The work plan will cover the period from the beginning until the end of the period of performance of the agreement. The Recipient will submit to CCC for approval an annual update to the work plan in each subsequent Federal government fiscal year during the period of performance of the agreement, according to a schedule specified by CCC. The annual update for each fiscal year will provide any updated information needed to ensure that the work plan is current and accurate.

D. The Recipient will, within three months after both parties have signed this agreement, submit to CCC for approval a performance monitoring plan and an evaluation plan that comply with the requirements in 7 CFR section 1499.12 and with IFAD's Monitoring and Evaluation Policy located at: https://www.fas.usda.gov/sites/default/files/2019-06/fad_mande_policy_feb_2019.pdf. The Recipient will conduct performance monitoring and evaluations in accordance with the plans approved by CCC. Before making any changes to its approved performance monitoring plan or evaluation plan, the Recipient must submit the proposed changes to CCC and obtain CCC's approval in writing.
Furthermore, within six months after both parties have signed this agreement, or a longer time period if agreed upon in writing by the Recipient and CCC, the Recipient must submit the results of any baseline study to CCC and request that the Performance Indicators, Attachment D, be updated to incorporate such results.

E. The Recipient will submit semiannual financial reports to CCC, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.13(b). The reporting periods will be April 1 through September 30 and October 1 through March 31. The Recipient must submit the report for each reporting period no later than 30 days after the end of the reporting period (i.e., October 30 for the April 1 through September 30 reporting period and April 30 for the October 1 through March 31 reporting period); provided, however, that if the first semiannual financial report would cover a partial reporting period and be due less than 60 days after the effective date of the agreement, the Recipient will be exempted from submitting a report for such partial reporting period, and the Recipient's first semiannual financial report will cover the period from the effective date of the agreement through the first full reporting period and be due no later than 30 days after the end of such reporting period. The Recipient must submit the final financial report no later than 120 days after the end date of the period of performance for this agreement.

F. (1) The Recipient will submit semiannual performance reports to CCC, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.13(c). The reporting periods will be April 1 through September 30 and October 1 through March 31. The Recipient must submit the report for each reporting period no later than 30 days after the end of the reporting period (i.e., October 30 for the April 1 through September 30 reporting period and April 30 for the October 1 through March 31 reporting period); provided, however, that if the first semiannual performance report would cover a partial reporting period and be due less than 60 days after the effective date of the

agreement, the Recipient will be exempted from submitting a report for such partial reporting period, and the Recipient's first semiannual performance report will cover the period from the effective date of the agreement through the first full reporting period and be due no later than 30 days after the end of such reporting period. The Recipient must submit the final performance report no later than 120 days after the end date of the period of performance for this agreement.

(2) In each semiannual performance report, the Recipient will report its progress toward achieving the targets in the performance indicators contained in Attachment D. Each performance indicator will contribute to the achievement of one of the results outlined in the Project-level Results Framework, Attachment E. Attachments D and E will be attached to and made a part of this agreement when the parties amend this agreement in accordance with Part I, Paragraph I. CCC will assess the Recipient's performance under the agreement by comparing, for each performance indicator in Attachment D, the annual targets with the outcomes or outputs achieved by the Recipient, taking into account any circumstances that might have affected performance, including any circumstances beyond the control of the Recipient.

G. The Recipient will submit evaluation reports for the agreement to CCC, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.13(d) and IFAD's Monitoring and Evaluation Policy. The reports must be submitted in accordance with the timeline in the CCC-approved evaluation plan.

H. The Recipient will enter into a written contract with each provider of goods, services, or construction work valued at or above the Simplified Acquisition Threshold, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.11(k). The Recipient will submit a copy of each such signed contract to CCC.

I. The Recipient will consult CCC prior to the selection of any subrecipient. The Recipient will enter into an agreement with each subrecipient that will set forth the responsibilities of both parties. The Recipient will submit a copy of each subrecipient agreement to CCC within 60 days after signing the subrecipient agreement and prior to the transfer of any donated commodities, sale proceeds, CCC- provided funds, or program income to the subrecipient, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.14(a). The Recipient will obtain written approval from CCC before making any changes to any information regarding a subrecipient specified in section 4(d) of Attachment A.

J. The Recipient will inform CCC, in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.12(c), of any problems, delays, or adverse conditions that materially impair the Recipient's ability to meet the objectives of this agreement. This notification must include a statement of any corrective actions taken or contemplated by the Recipient, and any additional assistance requested from CCC to resolve the situation. The Recipient must make this notification by sending an e-mail message to the Senior Director, IFAD, at PPDED@fas.usda.gov within 30 days after the date on which the Recipient becomes aware of such a problem, delay, or adverse condition.

K. If the Recipient uses funds under this agreement to establish a Federal interest in real property, such as through construction, the Recipient will submit to CCC a Standard Form 429, Real Property Status Report. The Recipient will submit this form to CCC before it uses funds under this agreement to acquire, improve, furnish, or dispose of any real property in which there is a Federal interest and will continue to submit the form on an annual basis, beginning on a date specified by CCC, until the disposition of the property by the Recipient in accordance with 2 CFR section 200.311.

L. Except as otherwise provided in this agreement or communicated by CCC to the Recipient in writing, the Recipient will submit any reports, information, or requests required by or related to this agreement, and any other submissions required in 7 CFR part 1499, to the Senior Director, IFAD, through the Food Aid Information Service (FAIS). The Recipient will consult FAIS at https://apps.fas.usda.gov/FAIS/webapp/ for required forms and instructions. If questions arise related to this agreement, the Recipient may send a message to PPDED@fas.usda.gov to seek assistance.

M. The information collection requirements contained in this agreement have been approved by the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) under the provisions of 44 U.S.C. Chapter 35 and assigned OMB

Number 0551-0035 (expires April 30, 2024). Persons are not required to respond to a collection of information unless it displays a currently valid OMB control number.

Item III – Certification and Compliance Requirements

A. The Recipient asserts that it has taken action to ensure that any donated commodities that will be distributed to beneficiaries will be imported and distributed free from all customs, duties, tolls, and taxes. The Recipient has submitted information to CCC to support this assertion.

B. The Recipient asserts that, to the best of its knowledge, the importation and distribution of the donated commodities in Mauritania will not result in a substantial disincentive to or interference with domestic production or marketing in Mauritania. The Recipient further asserts that the importation of the donated commodities and the use of any local currency sale proceeds for development purposes will not have a disruptive impact on the farmers or the local economy of Mauritania. The Recipient has submitted information to CCC to support these assertions.

C. The Recipient asserts that, to the best of its knowledge, any sale or barter of the donated commodities will not displace or interfere with any sales of United States commodities that would otherwise be made to or within Mauritania. The Recipient has submitted information to CCC to support this assertion.

D. The Recipient asserts that adequate transportation and storage facilities will be available in Mauritania at the time of the arrival of the donated commodities to prevent the spoilage or waste of the donated commodities. The Recipient has submitted information to CCC to support this assertion.

E. The Recipient will comply with the Terms and Conditions Regarding the Acknowledgment of USDA Funding, the Use of the USDA Logo, and Communications to the Public, Attachment F, which is attached hereto and made a part of this agreement.

F. The Recipient will comply with the audit requirements in 7 CFR section 1499.18.

G. The Recipient will disclose to CCC all violations of Federal criminal law involving fraud, bribery, or gratuity violations potentially affecting this agreement. The Recipient must make this disclosure by sending an e-mail message to the Senior Director, IFAD, at PPDED@fas.usda.gov within 30 days after the date on which the Recipient becomes aware of such a violation.

H. During the agreement closeout process, the Recipient will submit a tax certification letter on company letterhead indicating that it has paid in full all taxes for its employees working in [Country] to implement this agreement. The Recipient will also submit the equipment disposition form required by CCC. In accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.13(h) and 2 CFR section 200.334, the Recipient must retain records related to this agreement for a period of three years from the date of submission to CCC of the final financial report.

I. As a condition of this cooperative agreement, the Recipient assures and certifies that it is in compliance, and will comply during the course of this agreement, with all applicable laws, regulations, and Federal Executive Orders. The Recipient will also comply with FAS's Award General Terms & Conditions for Grants and Cooperative Agreements, as applicable, found at https://www.fas.usda.gov/grants-and-cooperative-agreements-administrative-general-terms-and- conditions and https://www.fas.usda.gov/grants-and-cooperative-agreements-national-policy-general- terms-and-conditions; provided, however, that if such an award term or condition is inconsistent with a provision of this agreement or a provision of a statute or regulation applicable to this agreement, the order of precedence will be: first, the applicable statute or regulation; second, the provision of the agreement; and third, the award term or condition.

PART IV
FINAL PROVISIONS

A. This agreement will enter into force upon the date of last signature. The Federal award date for this agreement, for the purposes of 2 CFR part 200, will be the date that it is signed by the authorized representative of CCC.

B. The period of performance and the budget period of this agreement start on the date on which the agreement enters into force and end on 09/30/2028.

C. The Recipient may object to an action taken by CCC in response to a failure of the Recipient to comply with this agreement, as provided in 7 CFR section 1499.17, by submitting its objection in writing to the Senior Director, IFAD, within 30 days after the date of CCC's written notification to the Recipient of the action.

D. This agreement may be suspended or terminated only in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.16.

In witness whereof, the representatives of the parties, duly authorized for the purpose, have signed this agreement.

FOR THE GOVERNMENT OF THE UNITED STATES OF AMERICA	FOR PARTNERS OF THE AMERICAS
By: MARK SLUPEK Digitally signed by MARK SLUPEK Date: 2023.09.21 14:02:42 -04'00'	By: John McPhail Digitally signed by John McPhail DN: cn=John McPhail, o=Partners of the Americas, ou=President's Office, email=jmcphail@partners.net, c=US Date: 2023.09.21 10:40:03 -06'00'
Mark Slupek	John McPhail
Title: Deputy Administrator, Global Programs, Foreign Agricultural Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture	Title: President & CEO
Date:	Date: September 21, 2023

ATTACHMENT A
PLAN OF OPERATION
FOOD FOR PROGRESS
FY 2023

1. NAME AND ADDRESS OF RECIPIENT

Partners of the Americas
1424 K Street
Suite 700
Washington, DC 20005

Contact at U.S. Headquarters
Sheila Posas
Sr. Director, Agriculture & Food Security
Tel. 2022363594
Email: sposas@partners.net

Contact in Mauritania
Abdel Aziz Dahi Chief
of Party 1424 K Street
Suite 700
Washington, DC
United States
Tel. 2022363594
Email: rmaher@partners.net

2. COUNTRY OF DONATION

Mauritania

3. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

(a) Project Objectives

Partners of the Americas (POA) will monetize 60,000 MT of Hard Red Winter Wheat and, over a period of approximately five years, use the proceeds from such sale to implement a project in Mauritania focused on achieving the following objectives:

- To increase agricultural productivity, through the adoption of climate smart agriculture methods and technologies in the horticulture sector.
- To increase agricultural trade in the horticulture sector.

(b) Project Implementation

As referenced in Part III, Item II, Paragraph C, POA will provide additional details of each activity within the submitted Work Plan. In addition to providing further activity details, POA will also define the intended beneficiaries, timing of implementation, geographic targeting, classification of intended procurements, including contracts and grants, and a breakdown of the implementation strategy, including the structure of implementation, to include roles and responsibilities of any subrecipient(s).

POA will use proceeds to implement the following activities:

Activity 1: Increase Production and Farmer Resiliency

POA will provide traditional and digital extension services to increase the adoption of essential climate- smart agriculture practices. POA will transfer extension materials and capacity to Private Agriculture

Service Providers (PASPs), who will support farmers through sustainable extension business models after the life of the project. POA will demonstrate and train farmers on the use of climate smart agriculture practices like drought-resistant seeds and intercropping. POA will work with farmers at all scales to use context-appropriate and environmentally sustainable mechanization to increase labor productivity. POA will generate and distribute agriculture information and data from innovative GIS and remote sensing technology to farmers, investors, PASPs, multinational agribusinesses, and the government of Mauritania to increase agricultural data availability that will lead to improved input-usage efficiency, larger yields, and decreased risks for farmers and potential investors. POA will bolster existing irrigation practices and innovative techniques that improve production and resilience.

Activity 2: Promote Regenerative Agriculture with Agropastoralists

POA will promote regenerative agriculture and improve food diversification and resilience with agropastoralists. POA will train community leaders and early adopters within ethnic minority agropastoral communities in climate-smart agriculture production to increase household nutrition and income opportunities. POA will use remote sensing technology to identify high-priority locations to establish bugger zones to combat desertification. POA will fund demonstration buffer zones and train farmers and other stakeholders on how to plant and maintain these buffer zones. Information generated through remote sensing will be used, in coordination with the Government of Mauritania, other development projects (World Bank and IFAD), and farmers/farmer groups, to plant buffer zones in identified areas. POA will also implement Social and Behavior Change activities such as nutrition classes with agropastoralists to improve diet diversification. Culturally appropriate activities will take a two-pronged approach: in-person training/sensitization and outreach campaigns using common modes of communication.

Activity 3: Improve the Agriculture Enabling Environment

POA will develop and implement a PASP certification program to increase the number of private extension agents with specialized horticulture and business management training. POA will certify recent graduates, existing PASPs, and other agriculture sector professionals in critical technical areas. POA will additionally create a general PASP business model and work with PASPs to draft and implement their own custom sustainable business plans. POA will improve agriculture education institutions' climate- smart agriculture technical capacity in areas such as GIS/remote sensing data and mechanization. POA will fund internships for agriculture school graduates at organizations such as farms and agribusinesses to increase the number of opportunities for high-level agricultural specialists. POA will increase women's cooperatives' capacity to function as agro-dealers to bulk purchase and distribute high-quality climate agriculture inputs. POA will deploy its out-grower model that connects private sector farmers who lack resources to private sector agribusinesses to achieve economies of scale through contract farming. To increase key ministries' capacity, POA will transfer knowledge through trainings to ministry workers on activities such as facilitating the out-grower model and using key data to support farmers. POA will establish an Ag Expo that will introduce farmers to innovations and technologies and provide opportunities for Mauritanian and US agribusinesses to market their products.

Activity 4: Build Capacity for Post Harvest

POA will co-invest with entrepreneurs in processing facilities to boost domestic food transformation through grant funding. POA will train processors and agribusinesses in relevant food safety certifications and practices. POA will provide competitive grants to enterprises that transform waste into marketable products such as organic fertilizer.

POA will attract private sector investment to establish cold storage across the horticulture value chain through a competitive grants program. POA will collaborate with the Global Cold Chain Alliance to conduct a cold chain feasibility study to illustrate opportunities for investment in large and small-scale green energy cold

storage.

POA will establish and host investment roundtable events that introduce investors to business opportunities in Mauritania's horticulture industry. At the roundtables, POA will present FFPr Mauritania production data and share promising opportunities in post-harvest storage and processing. POA will additionally send representatives from the public and private sectors to relevant international trade shows.

4. PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

(a) Method of Choosing Beneficiaries

POA will carry out activities under this agreement in USDA's target regions along the Senegal River Valley in Trarza, Brakna, Gorgol, Assaba, and Guidimakha. Within these five regions, POA will target small-scale farmers, cooperative members, and agropastoralists, including youth, women, and ethnic minorities. POA will identify farmers that exhibit the characteristics of "early adopters", people most likely to adopt innovations quickly, to reach critical mass more efficiently in the target regions. POA will also target large-scale farmers to scale commercial production. Other beneficiaries include private agriculture service providers (PASPs), students, professors, government officials, and agro-dealers.

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(b) Program Administration

POA will dedicate 21 in-country staff personnel and 2 headquarters staff personnel to implement this agreement.

(c) Expected Contribution

POA will contribute $600,000 in cost share in cash and in-kind contributions.

(d) Subrecipients

POA may select one or more subrecipients from among local and international organizations. To be eligible for selection as a subrecipient, an organization must have:

- Experience operating in the targeted region;
- Experience working with POA ;
- Experience in agricultural projects; and
- Experience in handling financial matters.

POA will enter into an agreement with each subrecipient that will set forth the responsibilities of both parties. POA will consult CCC prior to the selection of any subrecipient and provide a copy to CCC of each signed agreement with a subrecipient.

(e)Governmental or Non-governmental Entities

POA will work directly with the following entities:

Mauritanian government stakeholders including the Ministry of Agriculture, the Ministry of Livestock, and Food Security Agency.

The World Bank (PARIIS and PRAPS, Mauritanian non-governmental industry, civil society stakeholders, and donors including African Agriculture, National Horticulture Trade Association, International Fund for Agriculture Development (PRODEFI and PROGRESS), SONADER, World Food Program, African Development Bank, Mercy Corps, Higher Education Institute of Technology, Kaedi Agriculture schools, Lycee Agricole, among others.

Key activity collaboration organizations include:

- 6th Grain, an innovative GIS and remote sensing company with a presence in Mauritania that will build data usage capacity and boost farmer productivity.
- Global Cold Chain Alliance, a leading global cold chain expert that will conduct a green-energy cold chain feasibility study to facilitate investment in Mauritanian agribusinesses and enable post-harvest capacity through cold chain storage improvements.
- National Horticulture Trade Association, an association of Mauritanian horticulture farmers and cooperatives that will help identify early adopters, take on key activities for program sustainability and disseminate information and best practices produced by the project. They will also implement the Ag Expo.

5. USE OF FUNDS OR GOODS AND SERVICES GENERATED

(a) Quantity and Type of Commodities to be Sold or

Bartered Anticipated monetization completion date:

05/15/2024

Table - I

Commodity	Amount To Be Monetized [tons]MT
Hard Red Winter Wheat	60,000
TOTAL	60,000

(b)Amount of Sale Proceeds

Anticipated Table - II

Commodity Name	Amount To Be Sold [tons]MT	Estimated Sales Per MT	Estimated Proceeds
Hard Red Winter Wheat	60,000	$233.33	$13,999,800.00
Anticipated Interest Earned	-	-	$7,878.00
TOTAL	60,000		$14,007,678.00

Anticipated Interest Earned: $7,878.00

(c)Private Sector Participation in the Sale of Commodities

The monetization sales of commodities under this agreement will be conducted per normal commercial transactions in Mauritania, wherein the sales price will represent a fair market price equivalent to other imported commodities of comparable type, specifications, and quality. Sales terms will be cost and freight (Incoterm CFR) free out delivery terms. The sale of the commodity will be widely advertised in the local media to obtain as many bids as possible. POA will also directly contact potential buyers to encourage participation. If POA determines, based on a market survey, that a negotiated sale would ensure the most favorable price, POA may request approval within its monetization plan from the Director, Food Assistance Division, FAS, to conduct a negotiated sale. POA will keep the local U.S. Embassy and the Food Assistance Division, FAS, informed throughout the sale process. POA will provide in its sale contract(s) that the buyer will be responsible for the payment of any duties or taxes imposed on the donated commodities.

6.DESCRIPTION OF ANY REPROCESSING OR REPACKING

The monetization sales of commodities under this agreement will be conducted per normal commercial transactions in Mauritania, wherein the sales price will represent a fair market price equivalent to other imported commodities of comparable type, specifications, and quality. Sales terms will be cost and freight (Incoterm CFR) free out delivery terms. The sale of the commodity will be widely advertised in the local media to obtain as many bids as possible. POA will also directly contact potential buyers to encourage participation. If POA determines, based on a market survey, that a negotiated sale would ensure the most favorable price, POA may request approval within its monetization plan from the Director, Food Assistance Division, FAS, to conduct a negotiated sale. POA will keep the local U.S. Embassy and the Food Assistance Division, FAS, informed throughout the sale process. POA will provide in its sale contract(s) that the buyer will be responsible for the payment of any duties or taxes imposed on the donated commodities.

ATTACHMENT B
COMMODITY SPECIFICATIONS
HARD RED WINTER WHEAT

1. Class:	Hard Red Winter
2. Grade:	U.S. No. 2/ob
3. Protein:	Ordinary
4. Moisture (Max.):	13.5%
5. Dockage (Max):	0.6%
6. Test weight lbs/bu (Min.):	58.0
7. Falling Number (Min.):	300
8. Wheat of Other Classes (Max.):	2.0%

Packaging

Bulk or 50-kilogram woven polypropylene fabric and circular-woven style bags

ATTACHMENT C - 1
Budget Summary

Program: FFPr
Country of Operation: Mauritania
Implementing Organization: Partners of the Americas
Fiscal Year: 2023
Agreement Number: FCC-682-2023/013-00

Total Amount of Federal Funds Obligated

Funding Source	Funding Year	Commodity Cost (FFPr and MGD Only)	Freight Cost (FFPr and MGD Only)	Administrative Costs (cash portion)	Total Federal Funding Obligated
Commodity Credit Corporation (FFPr)	2023	$28,250,000.00	$5,900,000.00	$1,400,000.00	$35,550,000.00

Project Operating Budget

ExpenseType		Monetization Proceeds	CCC Funds (Admin Only)	Cost Share	Total w/out Cost Share	Total w/Cost Share
Administration (Flexible Line Items)						
	Other	$65,166.84	$13,425.00	$0.00	$78,591.84	$78,591.84
	Supplies	$11,144.42	$25,968.00	$0.00	$37,112.42	$37,112.42
	Office	$369,492.55	$14,990.00	$0.00	$384,482.55	$384,482.55
	Equipment	$130,000.00	$0.00	$0.00	$130,000.00	$130,000.00
	Professional Services	$1,167,600.00	$250,000.00	$0.00	$1,417,600.00	$1,417,600.00
	Travel	$170,974.97	$37,563.00	$0.00	$208,537.97	$208,537.97
	Benefits	$140,988.73	$265,417.00	$0.00	$406,405.73	$406,405.73
	Salaries	$340,514.28	$484,000.00	$0.00	$824,514.28	$824,514.28
Total Administration		$2,395,881.79	$1,091,363.00	$0.00	$3,487,244.79	$3,487,244.79
Activities (Flexible Line Items)						
	Activity 1: Increase Production and Farmer Resiliency	$2,098,881.98	$0.00	$0.00	$2,098,881.98	$2,098,881.98
	Activity 2: Promote Regenerative Agriculture with Agropastoralists	$1,825,819.03	$0.00	$0.00	$1,825,819.03	$1,825,819.03
	Activity 3: Improve the Agriculture Enabling Environment	$1,995,172.44	$0.00	$0.00	$1,995,172.44	$1,995,172.44
	Activity 4: Build Capacity for Post Harvest	$2,604,012.75	$0.00	$600,000.00	$2,604,012.75	$3,204,012.75
Total Activities		$8,523,886.20	$0.00	$600,000.00	$8,523,886.20	$9,123,886.20
ITSH (Non-flexible Line Items)						
Total ITSH		$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00
Total Direct Costs		$10,919,767.99	$1,091,363.00	$600,000.00	$12,011,130.99	$12,611,130.99
ICR on Administration		$2,410,555.00	$0.00		$2,410,555.00	

ICR on Activities	$677,555.00	$308,637.00		$986,192.00	
ICR on ITSH	$0.00	$0.00		$0.00	
Total Indirect Costs	$3,088,110.00	$308,637.00		$3,396,747.00	
Anticipated Program Income					$7,878.00
Grand Total Costs	$14,007,877.99	$1,400,000.00	$600,000.00	$15,407,877.99	$16,007,877.99
Total Amount of Federal Award (Total Federal Funds Obligated plus Cost Share): $36,150,000.00					

ATTACHMENT C-2

BUDGET NARRATIVE

Program	**Food for Progress**
Country	**Mauritania**
Fiscal Year	**2023**
Organization	**Partners of the Americas, Inc.**
Point of Contact	**Michael Moscarelli, mmoscarelli@partners.net**

I. General Explanatory Comments

Partners of the Americas Inc. (POA) will implement a five-year Food for Progress (FFPr) Program project in Mauritania. The total federal award amount is $35,550,000. This includes commodities ($28,250,000), freight ($5,900,000), and administrative costs (cash portion) ($1,400,000). The total operating budget (grand total costs) for this project is $15,600,000; this includes $600,000 in cost share. POA expects interest on proceeds to be $7,878. The following budget narrative describes the operating budget and does not describe the commodity and freight portions of Federal funding. The narrative is set up per the NOFO guidance and subsequent amendments. Please see the following summaries below, as requested on pages 81 & 82 of the NOFO.

Gross Monetization Proceeds	$14,000,000
CCC Admin Funds	$1,400,000
Interest	$7,878
Cost Share	$600,000
Total	**$16,007,878**

Total Project Operating Budget (including cost share and interest) $16,007,878

Summary of Total Project Operating Budget (Includes Cost Share)	
Administration	$3,487,244.80
Activities	$8,723,886.20
ICR on Administration	$986,192
ICR on Activities	$2,410,555
Total	**$16,007,878**

POA aims to maximize funding going towards direct program activities. POA's operating budget (including cost share) directs **57% of the funds to program activities, and 43% is for administration and indirect costs.**

Summary of POA Indirect Rates Applied **$3,396,747**

Summary of Total Indirect Costs Applied	
Total Administration Direct Costs	$3,487,244.80
Total Activities Direct Costs	$8,523,886.20
Indirect Costs Applied on Administration 28.28%	$986,192
Indirect Costs Applied on Activities 28.28%	$2,410,555
Total Indirect Costs	**$3,396,747**

Summary of M&E Budget **$965,500**

Summary of M&E Budget (Excluding M&E Personnel & Travel)	
Evaluations (Baseline, Midterm, & Final)	$485,000
Impact Evaluation	$200,000
Special Study	$200,000
Monitoring Guidelines Creation, Translation & Printing	$10,000
Monitoring Guidelines Revision, Translation & Printing	$8,000
Monitoring Guidelines Staff Training on Indicators and Data Collection/Analysis	$30,000
M&E Database Platform Subscription (includes training)	$32,500
Total M&E Budget	**$965,500**
Total Budget % Dedicated to M&E (Excluding Cost Share)	**6.26%**

POA believes that M&E is a critical component for successful programmatic implementation; therefore, POA has allotted approximately 6.26% ($965,500) of the total budget (excluding cost share) to M&E-related activities. In the field, POA will have a dedicated M&E Director and an M&E Specialist with 100% LOE throughout the 5 years of the project. In addition to these staff, POA will implement a robust system for M&E evaluation, tracking, and reliable data collection. This includes costs for M&E external third-party evaluations, a special study, M&E guidelines training, license and implementation of M&E software, and M&E data collection site visits. In addition, POA will bring its prior experience in data collection to help train staff. POA will provide its training materials, tools, and other resources to help staff with the M&E aspects of the project. These resources will be offered to the project at no cost to USDA.

Budget Assumptions and Cost Escalations

POA has established a local hire pay scale for Mauritania in accordance with market rates for the level of experience and education required. The salary scale for local hires was established based on comparable organizations and projects, information gathered from in-country consultants, online research, and market analysis for similar positions and experience levels. POA has applied a 4% increase to account for inflation and merit-based salary increases for all U.S. Nationals (USN)/Third Country Nationals (TCN) staff, Headquarters (HQ), and Cooperating Country National (CCN) staff after Year 1 (Y1), in accordance with POA policy. Actual annual increases will range between 1%-5% and are based on an annual performance review.

Expenses for travel, office supplies & personal protective equipment, and office expenses include a yearly escalation for inflation after Y1. Inflation is estimated at 4% annually after Y1.

All equipment (over $5,000) purchases will be made under the guidance of POA, unless otherwise indicated. To the extent possible, all equipment will be procured in Mauritania, in accordance with standard procurement practices, to eliminate shipping and handling costs. Travel costs for domestic in-country travel and per diem rates are budgeted based on local prevailing transportation, and lodging costs in Mauritania are based on a reduced rate of the U.S. Department of State per diem thresholds. International air travel is budgeted based on the prevailing cost of economy-class tickets for the proposed routes and will be Fly America Act compliant. The international lodging and per diem rates budgeted are based on a reduced U.S. Department of State lodging rate and POA's prior experience.

Financial Capacity

POA has established sound financial management and internal control systems, ensuring expenditures are reasonable, allowable, and classified in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles (GAAP). POA uses cloud-based accounting software and is subject to an annual single audit. The Finance and Administration (F&A) department is staffed with professionals with over 100 years of combined experience in finance and accounting, auditing, and managing financial reporting for federal grants, contracts, and cooperative agreements. The F&A department comprises a Chief Financial Officer (CFO), Controller, Deputy Controller, Director of Compliance for Grants and Contracts, Budget Analyst, Accounts Payable Finance Officer, and two Senior Field Finance Officers. The F&A team works closely with project staff at POA HQ and in-country staff to monitor spending, ensure that all costs are reasonable and allowable, and support project staff to implement the project in accordance with USG rules and regulations (particularly 2 CFR 200), local laws, as well as POA's internal policies. Our F&A department also reviews spending with project directors monthly and assists with the oversight of contracts, end-of-project reporting, and other aspects of project monitoring.

Cost Application Methodology

POA uses a robust and cost-effective strategy to determine cost allocation in accordance with USG cost principles, local laws, and internal policies. Our proposed budget for this project was developed by conducting thorough price analyses to identify reasonable, realistic, and fair market values for all projected expenses. Our budget estimates were also calculated based on past experience implementing effective and cost-efficient USG-funded programs. POA follows U.S. and local labor laws to determine salary and fringe benefits for all employees identified in this proposal. Indirect Costs have been applied in accordance with POA's most recent NICRA agreement approved by our cognizant agency, USAID. In preparing the budget, POA has minimized administrative and support costs for managing the project to the extent possible to maximize the funds available for project activities while still ensuring overall award compliance and capacity building for implementing partners. As a result, 57% of the operating budget, including cost share, will be direct towards activities and 43% to administration and indirect costs.

Budget Components and Project Implementation

FFPr Mauritania's budget allocated to each activity will allow for effective project implementation. POA's budget uses rigorous evidence and references previous costs of similar projects implemented in Mauritania by donors such as the World Bank, the United Nations International Fund for Agriculture Development, and USAID. Activity 1 will appropriately fund demonstration sites for farmers and cover associated training costs, a contract with 6th Grain (a US-based GIS and remote sensing company) to produce high-impact agricultural data and introduce and improve new and innovative irrigation solutions for farmers. Activity 2 will promote regenerative agriculture with agropastoralists through training on horticulture production, planting Horticulture Tree Buffer Zones that mitigate desertification, and conducting Social and Behavior Change radio and in-person "Farmer Field Days" activities and outreach. The budget for these activities will ensure sufficient resources flow toward training, tree planting, and communications campaigns. Activity 3 will invest in agro-dealers and women's cooperatives "Agribusiness hubs, Private Agriculture Service Provider certification program, agriculture school's improvement, Outgrower Model contract farming development, launch the Mauritanian Ag Expo, and build governments capacity to support agriculture and sustain investment. The budget will allow for all

these activities to be implemented effectively; for example, building the Private Agriculture Service Provider certificate program considers the cost of designing the program, room, and board for trainees, and start-up funds for graduates. Activity 4 optimizes USDA's investment by incentivizing significant cost share opportunities. POA will work with the Global Cold Chain Alliance to build an investment portfolio for post-harvest capacity investment. This market study will reveal a suite of investment options in post-harvest storage and processing through appropriate project cost share input. POA is confident that all activities are appropriately funded to ensure quality implementation of proposed activities.

Cost Effectiveness

In compliance with the NOFO requirements, POA's budget is organized by activity and apportions costs for implementing the project's four activities. The budget has been developed considering cost-effectiveness to support and achieve the key objectives. The project's budget components were designed to build long-term human capital and leverage private sector resources. The project is cost-effective, namely because of the demand-based nature of activities and interest from the government and private sector to support and sustain activities. Up-front expenditure on innovative research and market studies will provide the project with precise information on how to meet the needs of beneficiaries. Studies and information made available through the project will incentivize the private sector to co-invest in activities and ensure the long-term viability of any USDA investment. Funds will be dispersed with precision, deferring to data-driven spending decisions. POA anticipates that funds spent on new linkages will exponentially increase agriculture sector output and two-way trade, creating an excellent return on investment for all stakeholders.

Anticipated Interest Earned

FFPr Mauritania expects that interest accrued on monetization proceeds will be $7,878 over the life of the project (LOP) based on an investment of the fund in an interest-bearing account with Bank of America. Based on current quotes, the compounding interest rate for a separate interest-bearing savings account with Bank of America is 0.03%.

Management of Monetization Proceeds

Payment will be secured and received from the buyer(s) through an irrevocable Letter of Credit from a bank(s) acceptable to POA. Upon receipt of payment, the funds will be deposited into a separate U.S.-based interest-bearing U.S. dollar account under the supervision of POA's CFO, who will be responsible for the disbursement of funds once approval has been received from the President & CEO. Funds from the monetization proceeds will only be disbursed when an immediate cash need for project activities and prior approval from the President & CEO is obtained. POA's CFO and Controller oversee core functions related to award administration, accounting, internal controls, and financial reporting, with additional compliance support from the Grants and Contract Compliance Unit. The Grants and Compliance Unit will conduct periodic compliance spot checks and annual internal audits with POA and contractors. Annually POA undergoes a formal external audit, in which all bank accounts and release of funds are tested.

II. Administration

Total Administration Costs: $4,473,437 ($3,073,437 in monetization, $1,400,000 in CCC funds, $0 in cost share)

- **Total Direct Costs: $3,487,245** ($2,395,882 in monetization, $1,091,363 in CCC funds)

- **Total Indirect Costs: $986,192** ($677,555 in monetization, $308,637 in CCC funds)

2.1 Salaries/Personnel - Total $824,514 ($340,514 monetization, and $484,000 CCC funds)

USN/TCN Staff. USN/TCN benefits are budgeted for the Chief of Party (COP) for five years over LOP. The COP will be an expatriate who has worked in Mauritania or other similar operating environments for over 15 years and has the necessary USG background, compliance, and technical expertise. The COP will oversee a team of experts and support staff, prepare reports and work plans, align project initiatives with in-country priorities, and ensure project compliance with federal regulations. The COP's salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

CCN Staff. Budgeted at 100% LOE for all five years of the project, the Deputy Chief of Party (DCOP) will be a Mauritanian national with more than 10 years of experience working in Mauritania. The DCOP is responsible for ensuring technical quality in the design and implementation of project activities. Other CCN staff include 3 Technical Leads, Specialists for component 2, 3, and 4, 20 Extension Agents, M&E Director, M&E Specialist, F&A Director, Human Resource Manager, Contracts & Compliance Specialist, Accountant, Administrative Assistant, Security Guards, and 2 Drivers. The CCN staff salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities as appropriate for each role. The majority of CCN staff are budgeted to remain on the project throughout the life of the project, except for the 20 Extension Agents who will complete their work midway through Y3. The proposed salary rates align with market research, and local in-country consultations were conducted by POA. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

Headquarters (HQ) Staff. POA HQ salary rates are based on the current annual salaries of staff, POA's salary matrix, and industry benchmarking surveys. The POA HQ team will be led by the Senior Director of Agriculture & Food Security, who oversees the HQ team in the project's interventions, providing compliance and technical support. The HQ Program Manager will serve as the primary day-to-day support to the field team. They will be supported by the HQ Monitoring, Evaluation, Research, and Learning (MERL) Senior Director and HQ Compliance Team who are not directly billed to the project, but are included in POA's overhead cost rate (see NICRA letter). To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

2.2 Fringe Benefits – Total $406,405 ($140,988 in monetization, and $265,417 in CCC funds)

Fringe Benefits – HQ and USN/TCN

POA charges fringe benefit costs in accordance with POA's personnel policy and its NICRA letter. POA has charged a 23.47% fringe rate on HQ and USN/TCN salaries. Fringe benefits include insurance, mandatory taxes, pension, and other employee benefits. Total Headquarters and USN/TCN Administrative Fringe Benefits = $154,154.

Fringe Benefits CCN Mauritania

Fringe benefits for CCN staff are budgeted at 26.92% of their total salary and are based on

local labor law, in-country required benefits, and POA's fringe benefit policy. This includes:

- 13% - Social security CNSS (Caisse National de Sécurité Sociale)
- 2% - Medical CNSS (Caisse National de Sécurité Sociale)
- 5% - CNAM (Caisse Nationale d'Assurance Maladie)
- 6.92% - Annual leave 18 days (1.5 days per month of service)

Total CCN Fringe Administrative Benefits = $45,145.

Allowances – USN/TCN Staff

Allowances for USN/TCN staff are budgeted at 50% of their total salary and are based on allowance rates from the U.S. Department of State Office of Allowance and POA USN/TCN fringe benefit policy. This includes:

- 15% Cost of Living Adjustment
- 35% Post Hardship

Additionally, POA is budgeting for the following allowances which are part of POA's standard fringe benefit package for ex-pat COPs:

- Housing allowance: POA is budgeting $1,600/month based on the U.S. Department of State housing allowance and market research for housing in a secure location with on-site security and Wi-Fi for the ex-pat COP. The house will be made ready and furnished.
- Reallocation & demobilization allowance: POA is budgeting $30,000/year in Y1 and Y5. Per POA's ex-pat fringe benefit policy this allowance is intended to cover COP's initial flight to Mauritania, excess baggage, movement of household goods - shipment for land/sea container, and customs and taxes.
- Annual home of record and rest & recuperation (R&R) trips: POA is budgeting for roundtrip airfare at $1,700/trip for the ex-pat COP to take either annual home of record or R&R trip each year as allowable under the Foreign Affairs Manual (FAM).

The above allowances are reasonable given that they are in accordance with POA's fringe benefit policy for expatriates and are in alignment with the benefits allotted by the U.S. Department of State and the FAM. Given the challenging operating context and security concern in Mauritania, POA believes that these benefits are reasonable and must be provided to attract and retain a top experienced COP candidate to oversee the project.

Total USN/TCN Administrative Allowances = $207,106.

2.3 Travel – Total $208,538 ($170,975 in monetization and $37,563 in CCC funds)

International Travel ($64,454)

POA HQ staff will make 20 international trips to Mauritania during the period of performance. The purpose of the trips will be to provide monitoring, oversight, and technical guidance. The total HQ staff international travel cost (airfare) estimate is $36,831.

Mauritania staff will make 15 international trips during the period of performance. The purpose of the trips will be to hold meetings, attend technical training, and attend conferences. The Chief of Party and the DCOP will each make at least 3 international trips to HQ in Washington, DC. The total Mauritania staff international travel cost (airfare) estimate is $27,623.

Local Travel ($28,977)

POA estimates $9,479 in local ground transportation for 35 trips for HQ and Mauritania staff international travel.

POA estimates $19,499 in local ground transportation for Mauritania staff to make 180 domestic trips over LOP. The purpose of the trips will be to attend trainings and meetings as well as perform M&E and data collection.

Motorcycle and Vehicle Fuel ($7,522)

POA estimates the administrative cost for fuel expense for 2 vehicles and 20 motorcycles to be $150/month. The total vehicle fuel cost estimate is $7,522.

Per Diem ($107,584)

International Travel – HQ Staff: POA estimates $26,713 in lodging, meals, incidental expenses (M&IE), and other travel costs (visa, insurance, etc.). POA estimates lodging at $97/night and M&IE at $72/day for 20 trips of 7 days each. POA also estimates $1,083 in other travel related costs, estimated at $50/trip for 20 trips.

International Travel – Mauritania Staff: POA estimates $20,035 in lodging and M&IE, and other travel costs (visa, insurance, etc.). POA estimates lodging at $110/night and M&IE at $59/day for 15 trips of 7 days each. POA also estimates $812 in other travel-related costs, estimated at $50/trip for 15 trips.

Local Travel – Mauritania Staff: POA estimates $60,836 in lodging at a rate of $43/night and M&IE, estimated at $35/day for 36 trips per year of 4 days each.

2.4 Professional Services/Contractual – Total $1,417,600 ($1,167,600 in monetization, and $250,000 in CCC funds)

Professional Services

Monetization Agent Fee ($280,000)

The Monetization Agent fee is estimated at 2% of monetization proceeds received for $280,000.

Monetization Impact Assessment ($48,000)

POA estimates $48,000 for a monetization impact assessment to evaluate the market impact of the monetization.

Support Services ($124,100)

POA has included expenses related to support services over the life of the program. These costs are directly attributable to the project and include audit costs ($40,000); legal fees/services

($15,000); security services, risk assessments, and security assessments ($2,500); short-term technical advisors ($22,950), a start-up consultant ($21,150), and POA will contract Abdel Aziz Dahi to serve as a Technical Advisor of Trade Promotion & Strategic Partnership & Investment who is a Mauritanian national with more than 20 years of experience working at the highest levels of the Government of Mauritania ($22,500).

Evaluations

Evaluations ($685,000)

POA estimates external evaluation fees for the Baseline, Midterm, Final, and Impact Evaluations to be $150,000, $160,000, $175,000, and $200,000, respectively. POA will host an open procurement to select an external evaluator for the evaluations. POA will consider factors such as the soundness of the proposal, unique capabilities, cost, delivery schedule, technical competency, experience in Mauritania, etc. The Impact Evaluation is supplementary funds to collect additional impact evaluation data points on top of the Baseline, Midterm, and Final Evaluation.

Special Studies ($200,000)

POA proposes two special studies: 1) Horticultural Tree Buffer Zone Study and 2) Pastoralist Social Behavior Change Study. In Y2, POA will begin a study to assess the farm productivity and ecosystem impacts of incorporating horticulture buffer zones. In Y3, POA will begin the Pastoralist Social Behavior Change Study to determine what incentives, if any, increase pastoralists' willingness to cultivate mango trees to diversify their income and food sources. Both studies will cost $100,000, totaling $200,000, and will each run for three years. POA will go through a competitive bidding process to select the contractors. POA will consider factors such as the soundness of the proposal, unique capabilities, cost, delivery schedule, technical competency, experience in Mauritania, etc.

Monitoring Guidelines Development ($48,000)

POA will develop M&E guidelines, including the cost of creating, translating, and printing at a one-time rate of $10,000. As part of its adapting and learning process, POA also estimates $8,000 for any revisions to the guidelines, including translation and additional printing needed over LOP. Once the Monitoring Guidelines have been developed, POA will provide training to all staff on indicators and data collection/analysis, including ongoing training for existing and updated guidelines, for a total of $30,000.

M&E Database ($32,500)

POA estimates M&E database platform subscription fees, including training, to accurately track project data across regions and activities. The total M&E database cost is $32,500.

2.5 Equipment – Total $130,000 ($130,000 in monetization and $0 in CCC funds)

POA plans to purchase two 4x4 specialized vehicles ready for the deserts and rural areas. Based on local quotes, POA estimates the cost at $65,000/vehicle, including customs, taxes, and import fees, for a total of $130,000. POA will follow USDA procurement guidelines and sourcing requirements. POA conducted a buy vs. lease analysis and found it more cost-effective to purchase vehicles given the frequent travel for data collection, trainings, and site visits to locations 4+ hours from the capital city. The title for this equipment will be retained by POA.

2.6 Office – Total $384,483 ($369,493 in monetization and $14,990 in CCC funds)

POA estimates the cost of its main in-country office in Nouakchott and a satellite office in Rosso to be $384,483. The costs include communications costs (internet, phone, data); office rent, utilities, and security; banking and cash handling fees; courier fees/services and postage; recruitment/procurement advertising; meeting expenses which are intended to cover the cost for any printing of materials for programmatic meetings, and room rental and A/V equipment rental as needed; payroll processing and local accounting books preparation; and licenses and subscriptions for program management. To estimate these costs, POA hired a local consultant in Mauritania to obtain quotes from local providers for these services to establish the average rate for each cost.

2.7 Supplies – Total $37,113 ($11,145 in monetization and $25,968 in CCC funds)

Appliances ($23,369)

POA plans to purchase 12 desktop/laptop computers; 2 all-in-one printers, a photocopier, and a scanner; 1 projector; and office furniture for the in-country offices, including desks, chairs, tables, shelves, filing cabinets, safes, and A/C units). Estimated costs are $23,369.

Office Supplies ($13,744)

The budgeted monthly office supply and personal protective equipment (PPE) costs are estimated at $250. The costs cover all necessary office supplies such as notebooks, pens, calculators, office bags, clip files, registers, photocopy paper, flip chart paper, markers, transparency paper, flip chart boards, etc. Additionally, the PPE costs are intended to include but are not limited to masks, gloves, hand sanitizer, antibacterial wipes, and other PPE that will keep staff and other participants safe. POA estimates are based on past experience and market research.

2.8 Other – Total $78,592 ($65,167 in monetization and $13,425 in CCC funds)

Training ($37,500)

POA plans for $7,500 in training, workshop, conference, and registration fees per year for the life of the project. The price is based on a registration or training fee of $1,500/event or training and 5 trainings/events per year. The costs will cover trainings, workshops, and/or courses on USG Rules and Regulations, program management, and technical conference and registration fees as necessary for the successful implementation of the project. The total for training is $37,500.

Maintenance ($28,093)

POA estimates equipment and office repairs and maintenance ($8,124), motorcycle maintenance ($6,500) (note: motorcycles to be purchased under specific activities), and vehicle maintenance ($13,469) to be a total of $28,093.

Insurance ($12,999)

POA estimates property and liability insurance ($2,708), motorcycle insurance ($8,124) (note: motorcycles to be purchased under specific activities), and vehicle insurance ($2,167) to be a total of $12,999.

2.9 Indirect Costs – Administration – Total $986,192 ($677,555 for monetization and $308,637 for CCC)

In accordance with POA's most recently approved NICRA, indirect costs are estimated at $986,192.

III. Activities

- Total $11,134,441 ($10,934,441 in monetization funds and $600,000 in cost share)

- **Total Direct Costs: $8,723,886** ($8,523,886 in monetization funds and $600,000 in cost share)
- **Total Indirect Costs: $2,410,555** ($2,410,555 in monetization funds)

Activity 1: Increase Production and Farmer Resiliency – Total $2,098,882 ($2,098,882 in monetization funds and $0 in cost share)

3.1.1 Salaries/Personnel – $955,939

USN/TCN Staff. USN/TCN benefits are budgeted for the Chief of Party (COP) for five years over LOP. The COP will be an expatriate who has worked in Mauritania or other similar operating environments for over 15 years and has the necessary USG background, compliance, and technical expertise. The COP will oversee a team of experts and support staff, prepare reports and work plans, align project initiatives with in-country priorities, and ensure project compliance with federal regulations. The COP's salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

CCN Staff. Budgeted at 100% LOE for all five years of the project, the Deputy Chief of Party (DCOP) will be a Mauritanian national with more than 10 years of experience working in Mauritania. The DCOP is responsible for ensuring technical quality in the design and implementation of project activities. Other CCN staff include 3 Technical Leads, Specialists for component 2, 3, and 4, 20 Extension Agents, M&E Director, M&E Specialist, F&A Director, Human Resource Manager, Contracts & Compliance Specialist, Accountant, Administrative Assistant, Security Guards, and 2 Drivers. The CCN staff salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities as appropriate for each role. The majority of CCN staff are budgeted to remain on the project throughout the life of the project, except for the 20 Extension Agents who will complete their work midway through Y3. The proposed salary rates align with market research, and local in-country consultations were conducted by POA. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

3.1.2 Fringe Benefits – Total $345,361

Benefits for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 23.47% of the employee's base salary ($44,380). CCN Mauritania staff benefits are per local labor laws and are calculated at 26.92% of the employee's base salary ($206,435).

Allowances for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 50% of their total salary ($94,546).

3.1.3 Travel – Total $149,457

Local Travel ($127,949)

POA estimates $5,549 in local transportation for trainings at $100/trip for 51 trips over the LOP. In addition, to make training accessible, POA estimates $122,400 for transport stipends for participants to attend trainings at $10/participant for 6,000 participants per year in Y1 and Y2,

Motorcycle and Vehicle Fuel Expenses ($8,525)

Vehicle fuel for technical leads and motorcycle fuel for 9 motorcycles used by the project's extension agents under this activity is estimated at $170/month for 46 months.

Per Diem ($12,984)

POA estimates $12,984 in lodging at a rate of $43/night and M&IE at $35/day for trainings for 51 trips over LOP, each trip will be for 3 days.

3.1.4 Professional Services/Contractual – Total $428,825

The contractor, 6th Grain, will implement GIS and remote sensing technologies to model crop production potential and develop a digital registry of farmers in Y1-Y2 for a total of $300,000. POA has selected 6th Grain to conduct these activities based on its world-class GIS and remote sensing capabilities with a presence in Mauritania. The contract cost will include the cost to develop a digital registry and provide training to Mauritanian officials.

POA will contract two expert technical irrigation hydrology engineers to evaluate infrastructure installed by current and previous development projects to improve on-farm irrigation and large-scale infrastructure. These consultants will be contracted for 3 months each at $6,000/month. This is budgeted in Y1 for a total of $36,000. POA will select expert consultants through an open and competitive process.

POA will contract a firm to provide security services and conduct risk and security assessments under activity 1 to ensure the well-being of staff and program participants for $35,000 over LOP. Under activity 1, POA anticipates contracting other short-term technical advisors to support development of innovative techniques to improve production at $29,700 over LOP. Additionally, POA will contract Abdel Aziz Dahi to serve as a Technical Advisor of Trade Promotion & Strategic Partnership & Investment who is a Mauritanian national with more than 20 years of experience working at the highest levels of the Government of Mauritania ($28,125).

3.1.5 Equipment – Total $0

None.

3.1.6 Office – Total $0

None.

3.1.7 Supplies – Total $45,300

POA will procure seeds and tools in Y1-Y2 for demonstration plot set-up and maintenance with a unit cost of $3,750. POA will set up 2 plots in each of the 4 regions of implementation. The total is $30,000.

POA will procure 9 motorcycles with a unit cost of $1,100 based on local quotes for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $9,900.

POA will procure 9 tablets to assist with rural data collection with a unit cost of $600 based on market rates for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $5,400.

3.1.8 Other – Total $174,000

POA will implement the following training activities:

Development of Technical Package (Design, Printing & Translation) ($18,000)

A one-time cost has been budgeted in Y1 for the development of the technical assistance packages. The cost associated with this includes design, printing, and translation into multiple languages.

Publish Report for On-farm Irrigation (Design, Printing & Translation) ($18,000)

A one-time cost has been budgeted in Y2 for the publication of a report on the evaluation of on-farm irrigation. The cost associated with this includes design, printing, and translation into multiple languages.

Publish Report for Large-Scale Water Infrastructure (Design, Printing & Translation) ($18,000)

A one-time cost has been budgeted in Y2 for the publication of a report on the solutions and findings for large-scale water infrastructure best practices. The cost associated with this includes design, printing, and translation.

Demonstration Plots for Drip and Innovative Irrigation Solutions (2 drips, 2 aspersion/sprinklers, and 2 valley pivot plots) ($120,000)

Demonstration plots for drip and innovative irrigation solutions are being budgeted in Y1-Y2. The plots will be used to demonstrate innovative irrigation techniques such as drip, sprinkler aspersion, and valley pivots. POA estimates the cost at $20,000/plot for 6 total demonstration plots. The cost will cover setup, design, and materials for the demonstration plots. Based on quotes from International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD), the drip irrigation kits (pumps, tubes, filter, etc.) will vary based on exact size, however, each is estimated at $16,000/kit. The plots will also require a fence which is estimated at $3,000 per hectare based on IFAD quotes. Additionally POA estimates $300/plot for fertilizer, $300/plot for seeds, and $400/plot for tool kits (shovels, hoes, etc.) to tend to the plots.

Activity 2: Promote Regenerative Agriculture with Agropastoralists – Total $1,825,819 ($1,825,819 in monetization and $0 in cost share)

3.2.1 Salaries/Personnel – Total $894,149

USN/TCN Staff. USN/TCN benefits are budgeted for the Chief of Party (COP) for five years over LOP. The COP will be an expatriate who has worked in Mauritania or other similar operating environments for over 15 years and has the necessary USG background, compliance, and technical expertise. The COP will oversee a team of experts and support staff, prepare reports and work plans, align project initiatives with in-country priorities, and ensure project compliance with federal regulations. The COP's salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

CCN Staff. Budgeted at 100% LOE for all five years of the project, the Deputy Chief of Party (DCOP) will be a Mauritanian national with more than 10 years of experience working in Mauritania. The DCOP is responsible for ensuring technical quality in the design and implementation of project activities. Other CCN staff include 3 Technical Leads, Specialists for component 2, 3, and 4, 20 Extension Agents, M&E Director, M&E Specialist, F&A Director, Human Resource Manager, Contracts & Compliance Specialist, Accountant, Administrative Assistant, Security Guards, and 2 Drivers. The CCN staff salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities as appropriate for each role. The majority of CCN staff are budgeted to remain on the project throughout the life of the project, except for the 20 Extension Agents who will complete their work midway through Y3. The proposed salary rates align with market research, and local in-country consultations were conducted by POA. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

3.2.2 Fringe Benefits – Total $313,823

Benefits for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 23.47% of the employee's base salary ($36,865). Benefits for CCN Mauritania staff are in accordance with local labor laws and are calculated at 26.92% of the employee's base salary ($198,421).

Allowances for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 50% of their total salary ($78,537).

3.2.3 Travel – Total $59,522

Local Travel ($38,013)

POA estimates $5,549 in local transportation for trainings at $100/trip for 51 trips over the LOP. In addition, to make training accessible, POA estimates $32,465 for transport stipends for participants to attend trainings at $10/participant for 1,000 participants per year from Y2-Y4.

Motorcycle and Vehicle Fuel Expenses ($8,525)

Vehicle fuel for technical leads and motorcycle fuel for 6 motorcycles used by the project's extension agents under this activity is estimated at $170/month for 46 months.

Per Diem ($12,984)

POA estimates $12,984 in lodging at $43/night and M&IE at $35/day for trainings, for 51 trips over LOP, each trip will be for 3 days.

3.2.4 Professional Services/Contractual – Total $368,125

POA will enter into four consultant/contractual agreements as follows:

- $30,000: To design materials for outreach and awareness campaigns to promote horticulture activities within agropastoral communities in Y1; the cost includes translation into multiple languages.
- $180,000: To disseminate outreach and awareness campaigns to promote horticulture activities within agropastoral communities in Y3-Y5.
- $50,000: To contract 5 nurseries in Mauritania and Senegal at $10,000/nursery to grow mango, lime, native acacia, and other tree species in Y1.
- $18,000: To create outreach and sensitization materials for Social Behavioral Change activities to promote horticulture activities within agropastoral communities in Y2-Y4.

Consultants and contractors will be selected based on a competitive bidding process. POA will take into consideration factors such as the soundness of the proposal, unique capabilities of the bidder, the amount of the bid, delivery schedule, technical competency, etc.

POA will contract a firm to provide security services and conduct risk and security assessments under activity 2 to ensure the well-being of staff and program participants for $35,000 over LOP. Under activity 2, POA anticipates contracting other ad-hoc consultancy and advisory support services on regenerative and climate-smart agriculture and classes for regional nutrition for which POA has budgeted $27,000 over LOP.

PPOA will contract Abdel Aziz Dahi to serve as a Technical Advisor of Trade Promotion & Strategic Partnership & Investment who is a Mauritanian national with more than 20 years of experience working at the highest levels of the Government of Mauritania ($28,125).

3.2.5 Equipment – Total $0

None.

3.2.6 Office – Total $0

None.

3.2.7 Supplies – Total $10,200

POA will procure 6 motorcycles with a unit cost of $1,100 based on local quotes for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $6,600.

POA will procure 6 tablets to assist with rural data collection with a unit cost of $600 based on market rates for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $3,600.

3.2.8 Other – Total $180,000

Six Farmer Field Schools per year in Y2-Y4 have been budgeted to train 400 individuals in 20 communities. The trainings in the Farmer Field Schools will demonstrate economically feasible and culturally appropriate horticulture activities for adoption from agropastoral communities. Based on quotes from IFAD, the gravity irrigation kits (pumps, tubes, filter, etc.) will vary based on exact size, however, each is estimated at $7,000/kit. The plots will also require a fence which is estimated at $2,000 for the expected size. Additionally, POA estimates $500/plot for fertilizer, and $500/plot for seeds.

Activity 3: Improve the Agricultural-Enabling Environment – Total $1,995,172 ($1,995,172 in monetization and $0 in cost share.)

3.3.1 Salaries/Personnel – Total $890,638

USN/TCN Staff. USN/TCN benefits are budgeted for the Chief of Party (COP) for five years over LOP. The COP will be an expatriate who has worked in Mauritania or other similar operating environments for over 15 years and has the necessary USG background, compliance, and technical expertise. The COP will oversee a team of experts and support staff, prepare reports and work plans, align project initiatives with in-country priorities, and ensure project compliance with federal regulations. The COP's salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

CCN Staff. Budgeted at 100% LOE for all five years of the project, the Deputy Chief of Party (DCOP) will be a Mauritanian national with more than 10 years of experience working in Mauritania. The DCOP is responsible for ensuring technical quality in the design and implementation of project activities. Other CCN staff include 3 Technical Leads, Specialists for component 2, 3, and 4, 20 Extension Agents, M&E Director, M&E Specialist, F&A Director, Human Resource Manager, Contracts & Compliance Specialist, Accountant, Administrative Assistant, Security Guards, and 2 Drivers. The CCN staff salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities as appropriate for each role. The majority of CCN staff are budgeted to remain on the project throughout the life of the project, except for the 20 Extension Agents who will complete their work midway through Y3. The proposed salary rates align with market research, and local in-country consultations were conducted by POA. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

3.3.2 Fringe Benefits – Total $327,782

Benefits for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 23.47% of the employees' base salary ($44,380). Benefits for CCN Mauritania staff are in accordance with local labor laws and are calculated at 26.92% of the employees' base salary ($188,856).

Allowances for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 50% of their total salary ($94,546).

3.3.3 Travel – Total $233,828

Local Travel ($5,549)
POA estimates $5,549 in local transportation for trainings at $100/trip for 51 trips over the LOP.

Motorcycle and Vehicle Fuel Expenses ($7,522)

Vehicle fuel for technical leads and motorcycle fuel for 4 motorcycles used by the project's extension agents under this activity is estimated at $150/month for 46 months.

Per Diem ($220,757)

POA estimates $12,984 in lodging at $43/night and M&IE at $35/day for trainings, for 51 trips over LOP, each trip will be for 3 days. In addition, POA estimates $207,774 in lodging and M&IE for Private Agriculture Service Providers (PASPs) Certification Program participants at $160/week for 50 participants to attend 8 weeks of training in Y2-Y4.

3.3.4 Professional Services/Contractual – Total $110,125

POA will contract a consultant to develop the modules for the PASP Certification Program in Y1 for a total of $20,000. POA will select the consultant based on a competitive bidding process. POA will take into consideration factors such as the soundness of the proposal, unique capabilities of the bidder, the amount of the bid, delivery schedule, technical competency, etc.

POA will contract a firm to provide security services and conduct risk and security assessments under activity 3 to ensure the well-being of staff and program participants for $35,000 over LOP. Under activity 3, POA anticipates contracting other ad-hoc consultancy and advisory support services to support the PASP course implementation for which POA has budgeted $27,000 over LOP.

Additionally, POA will contract Abdel Aziz Dahi to serve as a Technical Advisor of Trade Promotion & Strategic Partnership & Investment who is a Mauritanian national with more than 20 years of experience working at the highest levels of the Government of Mauritania ($28,125).

3.3.5 Equipment – Total $0

None.

3.3.6 Office – Total $0

None.

3.3.7 Supplies – Total $6,800

POA will procure 4 motorcycles with a unit cost of $1,100 based on local quotes for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $4,400.

POA will procure 4 tablets to assist with rural data collection with a unit cost of $600 based on market rates for use by the Extension Agents. The total is $2,400.

3.3.8 Other – Total $426,000

Stipends for Student Internships ($144,000)
POA estimates $90,000 for student internship stipends for domestic internships at $6,000/stipend for 5 stipends per year from Y2-Y4. POA estimates $54,000 for student internship stipends for international internships at $18,000/stipend for 1 stipend per year from Y2-Y4. The internship stipends will help cover travel costs and participants' time. The amount is based on entry-level salary for extension agents in Mauritania.

POA will implement the following small grant activities:

Small Grant to Increase Women's Cooperatives' Capacity to Function as Agro-dealers ($30,000)
POA will provide 10 grants to women cooperatives in the amount of $3,000 to improve their storage infrastructure and purchase key inputs for business start-ups.

POA will implement the following training activities:

Capacity Building Meetings to Increase Women's Cooperatives' Capacity ($44,000)
One capacity building meeting per quarter for 10 cooperatives has been budgeted to support them in functioning as Agribusiness Hubs. The meetings will take place in Y2 and Y3.

Capacity Building Meetings to Increase Existing Agro-dealers Capacity ($12,000)
Two capacity-building meetings per year for 3 cities have been budgeted to enhance the capabilities of promising or innovative early-stage agro-dealers. The meetings will take place in Y2 and Y3.

PASP Certification Program ($36,000)
POA is estimating $1,500 per week for 8 weeks each year for materials and venue costs for the implementation of the PASP Certification Program in Y2-Y4. The PASP certification program cost is based quotes from ISET on a venue rental cost (including A/V equipment) of $250/day x 5 days a week for a total of $1,250, plus an additional $250 for printing and other training materials a week.

Course on Agricultural Mechanization ($100,000)
One course on agriculture mechanization has been budgeted and split into Y1 and Y2. The estimated cost includes trainers, venue, food, materials, and transportation costs. The course will improve technical institutions' capacity to educate students in agricultural mechanization. The cost for the course on agricultural mechanization was based on an estimated provided from CAT which was the cost for similar courses conducted in the region.

Develop Training Materials to Increase Women's Cooperatives' & Existing Agro-dealers Capacity (Printing & Translation) ($15,000)
POA will print and translate training materials into multiple languages to increase women's cooperatives and existing agro-dealers capacity for a total of $15,000 in Y2.

Advertising to Facilitate Outgrower Models ($7,500)

POA will use advertising to reach farmers and private sector partners to facilitate outgrower models in the tomato and carrot value chains. The estimate is for $2,500 per year in Y2-Y4.

Annual Agriculture Expo Event ($37,500)
Each Expo will last 2 days and host roughly 3,000 attendees. The first Expo will be launched in Y2 and will be fully funded by the project. The second Expo in Y3 will be partly funded by the project as the responsibility is transferred to the National Horticulture Trade Association. Costs include venue rental, materials, booths, per diem, transportation, etc. POA estimated the cost based on prior experience convening similar size events in the different regions we implement. The breakdown of the cost include $10,000/day x 2 days for a total of $20,000 for venue and booth costs which can accommodate 3,000 attendees. POA budgeted an additional, $3,320 for materials, banners, flyers and other printed items, $1,680 for transportation ($30/day x 2 days) and per diem ($40/day x 2 days) for 12 staff to attend the event.

Activity 4: Build Capacity for Post-harvest – Total $3,204013 ($2,604,013 in monetization and $600,000 in cost share.)

3.4.1 Salaries/Personnel – Total $890,001

USN/TCN Staff. USN/TCN benefits are budgeted for the Chief of Party (COP) for five years over LOP. The COP will be an expatriate who has worked in Mauritania or other similar operating environments for over 15 years and has the necessary USG background, compliance, and technical expertise. The COP will oversee a team of experts and support staff, prepare reports and work plans, align project initiatives with in-country priorities, and ensure project compliance with federal regulations. The COP's salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

CCN Staff. Budgeted at 100% LOE for all five years of the project, the Deputy Chief of Party (DCOP) will be a Mauritanian national with more than 10 years of experience working in Mauritania. The DCOP is responsible for ensuring technical quality in the design and implementation of project activities. Other CCN staff include 3 Technical Leads, Specialists for component 2, 3, and 4, 20 Extension Agents, M&E Director, M&E Specialist, F&A Director, Human Resource Manager, Contracts & Compliance Specialist, Accountant, Administrative Assistant, Security Guards, and 2 Drivers. The CCN staff salary is distributed between Administrative and Activities as appropriate for each role. The majority of CCN staff are budgeted to remain on the project throughout the life of the project, except for the 20 Extension Agents who will complete their work midway through Y3. The proposed salary rates align with market research, and local in-country consultations were conducted by POA. To account for annual salary increases, POA has increased the salary by 4% after Y1 through LOP.

3.4.2 Fringe Benefits – Total $327,610

Benefits for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 23.47% of the employee's base salary ($44,380). Benefits for CCN Mauritania staff are in accordance with local labor laws and are calculated at 26.92% of the employee's base salary ($188,685).

Allowances for USN/TCN staff are calculated at 50% of their total salary ($94,546).

3.4.3 Travel – Total $79,877

Local Travel ($44,546)

POA estimates $5,549 in local transportation for trainings at $100/trip for 51 trips over LOP, each trip will be for 3 days. In addition, POA estimates $38,998 for transport costs to international trade shows and events at $1,800 per trip for 4 trips per year over the LOP for a total of 20 trips. The $1,800/trip includes one international roundtrip airfare ($1,600 estimated), plus $200 for local ground transportation.

Motorcycle and Vehicle Fuel Expenses ($5,015)

Vehicle fuel for technical leads and motorcycle fuel for 1 motorcycle used by the project's extension agent under this activity is estimated at $100/month for 46 months.

Per Diem ($30,316)

POA estimates $12,984 in lodging at $43/night and M&IE at $35/day for trainings, for 51 trips per year of 3 days each. In addition, POA estimates $17,332 in lodging at an average rate of $100/night and M&IE at an average of $60/day for trips to trade shows and events for 4 trips per year of 5 days each that will be held internationally.

3.4.4 Professional Services/Contractual – Total $524,275

POA will contract a consultant to implement a Cold Chain Feasibility Study in Y1 and Y2 for a total of $350,000. POA will select the consultant based on a competitive bidding process. POA will take into consideration factors such as the soundness of the proposal, unique capabilities of the bidder, the amount of the bid, delivery schedule, technical competency, etc.

POA will contract a firm to provide security services and conduct risk and security assessments under activity 4 to ensure the well-being of staff and program participants for $35,000 over LOP. Under activity 4, POA anticipates contracting other ad-hoc consultancy and advisory support services on training of processors and agribusinesses in food safety practices, for which POA has budgeted $32,400 over LOP.

Additionally, POA will contract Abdel Aziz Dahi to serve as a Technical Advisor of Trade Promotion & Strategic Partnership & Investment who is a Mauritanian national with more than 20 years of experience working at the highest levels of the Government of Mauritania ($106,875).

3.4.5 Equipment – Total $539,650

For the equipment below, POA will issue a cash grant for the purchase, and the recipient will be responsible for procuring directly. However, POA plans to put stipulations into the grant mechanism for prior approval by POA before purchase, so there is oversight on these procurements to ensure they are competed competitively. Payment to the grant recipient will be made on a percentage reimbursement basis with the ability to withhold the final payment if the equipment is not available at the end of the project. Final reimbursement payments to the grant recipients will

be made at the end of the project.

The equipment will be titled under the recipient organization as they will be contributing substantially to the purchase. However, POA will issue grants with conditions on the equipment use, to ensure the equipment is available during LOP. Recipients will be expected to contribute about 50% of the cost, and POA will make this a requirement of the grant to be eligible for funding.

Post-harvest Processing Equipment and Infrastructure ($150,000)
POA plans to co-invest in export-scale processing infrastructure with local and foreign investors. The tenders are expected to be released in Y3.

Co-invest in Small-Scale Processing Infrastructure for Cooperatives ($100,000)
POA plans to co-invest in small-scale processing infrastructure with promising women's cooperatives and medium- to large-scale farmers. A total of 10 cooperatives will receive $10,000 during Y2 and Y3.

Large Scale Cold and Dry Storage Equipment and Infrastructure ($226,150)
In Y2, POA plans to co-invest in large-scale cold and dry storage equipment and infrastructure with local and foreign investors based on the information gathered in the Cold Chain Feasibility Study.

Transformation Equipment for Waste Reduction ($63,500)
In Y3, POA plans to co-invest and provide equipment that will incentivize businesses that convert agricultural waste into biofuels, organic fertilizers, and compost products.

3.4.6 Office – Total $0

None.

3.4.7 Supplies – Total $1,700

POA will procure 1 motorcycle with a unit cost of $1,100 based on local quotes for use by the Extension Agent.

POA will procure 1 tablet to assist with rural data collection with a unit cost of $600 based on market rates for use by the Extension Agent.

3.4.8 Other – Total $240,900

POA will implement the following small grant activities:

Small Grant to Cooperatives to Increase Small Scale Cold Storage Capacity ($200,000)
POA will provide 10 grants to women cooperatives of $20,000 to support purchasing on-farm cold and dry storage facilities and provide training.

Communications Costs to Release RFP to Co-invest in Export-Scale Processing Infrastructure

($1,000)
POA is estimating $1,000 in Y2 to cover communications costs related to the release of the Request for Proposals (RFP) to co-invest in export-scale processing infrastructure.

Communications Costs to Release RFP to Co-invest in Cold and Dry Storage ($1,000)
POA is estimating $1,000 in Y2 to cover communications costs related to the release of the RFP to co-invest in cold and dry storage.

Communications Costs to Release RFP to Innovative Waste Utilization Businesses ($500)
POA is estimating $500 in Y2 to cover communications costs related to the release of the RFP for innovative waste utilization businesses.

Investment Roundtables ($18,000)
At least one Investment Roundtable has been budgeted per year through the LOP to leverage the production data obtained through GIS/remote sensing to present it to relevant domestic and international private sector actors. Two roundtables will be held in Y3.

Food Safety Training for Farmers and Processors ($10,400)
Two trainings per year have been budgeted for food safety training for farmers and processors, including harvest, packaging, and storage. The trainings will take place in Y2 and Y3.

Event Registration for Trade Shows ($10,000)
POA estimates $500 per event registration to send groups, including agribusiness hubs, large-scale and domestic processors, and commercial farmers, to global food trade shows. POA is budgeting for 4 events per year through the LOP.

3.4.9 Cost-Share – Total $600,000

POA is proposing a total of $600,000 in cost share. Overall program value will be bolstered by these cost share contributions. Cost share will be realized in both in-kind and cash contributions. The types of costs that will be documented and counted as cost share will include:

- ***Venue Space for Investment Roundtables ($1,000)***: POA estimates venue space at $166.60 per roundtable based on prior experience, for a total of 6 roundtables. To obtain this cost share, POA plans to work with local investors and businesses to offer venue space for these roundtables.
- ***Cost Share for Post-Harvest Processing Equipment and Infrastructure ($210,000)***: POA expects to co-invest in export-scale processing infrastructure. The program will look for local and foreign investors to match USDA's investment with private sector investment.
- ***Cost Share for Co-invest in Small-Scale Processing Infrastructure for Cooperatives ($50,000)***: POA will collaborate with promising women's cooperatives and large-scale farmers to co-invest in small-scale processing infrastructure. POA intends to provide grants to 10 cooperatives. To be eligible for grant funding, cooperatives will be expected to offer co-investment of 50% of their award, equivalent to $5,000 per cooperative.
- ***Cost Share for Large Scale Cold and Dry Storage Equipment and Infrastructure ($339,000)***: POA has identified promising Mauritanian private sector partners interested in co-investing in large-scale cold and dry storage facilities.

3.5 Indirect Costs – Activities – Total $2,410,555

In accordance with POA's most recently approved NICRA, indirect costs are 28.28% of direct activity costs. Total Indirect Costs on Activities: $2,410,555.

Total Estimated Costs: $16,007,878 ($14,007,878 in monetization and interest, $1,400,000 in CCC funds, $600,000 in cost share)

Attachment F

Terms and Conditions Regarding the Acknowledgment of USDA Funding, the Use of the USDA Logo, and Communications to the Public

Food for Progress Program

I. General Requirements

The Recipient will comply with the requirements in 7 CFR section 1499.8(d) and with these terms and conditions in implementing a project under this agreement.

II. Acknowledgment of USDA Funding

A. The Recipient will notify beneficiaries and officials in the target country that the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) provided funds for the activities under this agreement. The Recipient will publish notifications in local newspapers to highlight its activities under this agreement and identify USDA and the Food for Progress Program as the funding source of these activities. The Recipient will recognize USDA and the Food for Progress Program as the source of funding in all printed materials produced with USDA resources under this agreement.

B. The Recipient will prominently display signs that inform beneficiaries that funding for the project was provided by USDA and the Food for Progress Program at all USDA-supported activity implementation sites and events unless a waiver in accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.8(e) or (f) is applicable. These sites and events include, but are not limited to, commodity distribution sites, schools, demonstration plots, farms, and construction or rehabilitation activities.

C. The Recipient will comply with 2 CFR section 415.2, Acknowledgement of USDA Support on Publications and Audiovisuals.

III. Use of the USDA Logo

A. The Recipient will use the USDA logo in all communications to the public, promotional materials, vehicles, and structures that are produced, purchased, or constructed using funds provided or sale proceeds realized under the Food for Progress Program. This will include, but not be limited to, publications, posters, websites, signs, presentations, t-shirts, aprons, hats, instructional materials, handwashing stations, latrines, hygiene rooms, water tanks, and demonstration plots.

B. The Recipient will use the USDA logo in accordance with the 2013 USDA Visual Standards - https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/visual-standards-guide-january-2013.pdf Guide and the official USDA Style Guide website - https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/visual- standards-guide-january-2013.pdf.

C. The Recipient will place the USDA logo and the text "United States Department of Agriculture – Food for Progress Program" in the upper left corner of communications material or other marked item, unless otherwise approved by FAS. The Recipient may also add the American flag. The Recipient will not use project-specific logos.

D. The Recipient will not use the USDA logo on administrative materials such as stationery and business cards.

E. The Recipient may use the USDA logo in conjunction with a symbol of the target country, another donor, or a nongovernmental organization that is involved in the project, subject to the following conditions:

- The USDA logo with the text "United States Department of Agriculture – Food for Progress Program" will be placed prominently on the upper left corner of the item being marked.
- The other symbol(s) will be placed to the right of the USDA logo, provided that, with advance approval by FAS, the symbol of the target country may be placed to the left of the USDA logo in a situation where such placement would be advantageous to the success of the project.
- The placement of the USDA logo will be at least as favorable, in terms of size and prominence, as the placement of the other symbol(s).

F. The Recipient may choose not to place the USDA logo on, or otherwise mark, target country government-owned products if marking would undercut host-country "ownership" of policies, studies, reports, publications, or other communications better positioned as "by" or "from" a target country ministry or government official. In such cases, the Recipient will acknowledge USDA, as appropriate, within document text or verbally at meetings and events.

IV. Communications to the Public

A. Project Naming Criteria

When naming the project to be implemented under this agreement, the Recipient will:

- Begin with "U.S. Department of Agriculture" followed by the program name (e.g., U.S. Department of Agriculture Food for Progress Program) and will not use "FFPr."
    - Reference the country or region where the project is focused. If the project is global in nature, either omit the country or region, or include the word "global" instead.
    - Be clear, concise, simple, and descriptive.
    - Not use jargon or acronyms.
    - Not reference the Recipient's internal organizational structures (e.g., "Recipient's Colombia Value Chain Activity").

B. Project Communication Plan

The Recipient will submit a Project Communication Plan as an appendix to the annual work plan. The Project Communication Plan will include the following information:

- The central project message.
- An "official" translation of the project name and central project message. The Recipient must obtain approval of the translation from FAS before procuring or printing promotional materials.
- A description of how the Recipient intends to use the USDA logo in conjunction with a symbol of the target country, another donor, or a nongovernmental organization that is involved in the project, if applicable.
- The names of any other donors or nongovernmental organizations involved in the project and their communications and marking plans as they relate to the project.
- Any research publications expected to result from project funding, as well as any anticipated authorship issues, and how they will be handled.
- A Marking Plan (sample in Annex 1), which will include:
    - Types of materials that the Recipient intends to produce and mark.
    - The type and number of social media accounts the Recipient seeks approval from FAS to create, if applicable.

- The approximate number of project sites that the Recipient plans to mark.
- Anticipated events, listed by fiscal year, and any potential communication materials that will be released before, during, or after each event, e.g., press releases, success stories, etc.

C. Media Communications

1. *General*

a. The Recipient will notify the appropriate USDA program analyst and USDA Post of all media interactions in the same communication or as close to simultaneously as possible.

b. The Recipient will not claim the status of, and will not take any action that is likely to lead to it being perceived as, a USDA employee or member of the U.S. Government or Diplomatic Mission.

2. *Press Conferences, Interviews, and Speaking Engagements*

The Recipient will notify USDA in advance of any scheduled press conferences, interviews, or speaking engagements with the media regarding the project to be implemented under this agreement. In the event of an unexpected or unplanned media engagement, the Recipient will notify the appropriate USDA program analyst and USDA Post as soon as possible to enable them to inform the U.S. Embassy Public Affairs Section. The Recipient will ensure that its project staff or other appropriate personnel acknowledge U.S. Government support and USDA as the source of funding during any press or media engagement with the Recipient.

3. *Press releases*

The Recipient will include the following standard language in a footnote at the bottom of any press release related to the project implemented under this agreement:

"The USDA Food for Progress Program helps developing countries and emerging democracies modernize and strengthen their agricultural sectors. Food for Progress has two principal objectives:

to improve agricultural productivity and to expand trade of agricultural products. For more information, visit https://www.fas.usda.gov/programs/food-progress."

4. *Social Media*

a. The Recipient may create a project-specific social media account only if it demonstrates to USDA that there is a clear connection between the use of social media and the achievement of the project's objectives, and the Recipient obtains approval from USDA to create such project- specific social media account. In using an approved project-specific social media account, the Recipient will:

- Include only content that provides clear and accurate information that is focused on the project, consistent in quality and accessibility, family friendly, positive, and used to advance the project's development objectives.
- Include only posts that are consistent with stated USDA public positions, messaging, and communications strategies.
- Include high-quality pictures in the content, whenever possible.
- Place the USDA logo only on the introductory and closing frames of a video and include the USDA URL in the closing frame of a video.

- Maintain the privacy of project staff and beneficiaries.
- Take appropriate precautions to safeguard accounts from unauthorized use, hacking, or defacement.
- Tag relevant USDA accounts (@USDAForeignAg on X (formerly Twitter)) or hashtags.
- Include a disclaimer that the information in the account does not necessarily reflect the views of the U.S. Government.
- Archive and deactivate all project-specific social media accounts at the end of the project.
- Not include any disparaging remarks, including such remarks about the U.S. Government, the target country government, or U.S. agricultural products.
- Not advocate for target country government policies that disadvantage U.S. agricultural exports.
- Not use social media to respond to reports in other media, such as newspapers, broadcast, and online reports.

b. The Recipient may use its organization's social media platform to inform beneficiaries and the public about the project's objectives and achievements. In social media posts related to the

project, the Recipient must identify USDA as the funder and include the program name. The Recipient will tag the USDA handle (@USDAForeignAg) in messages delivered though X (formerly Twitter) related to the project, whenever possible. The Recipient must notify the appropriate USDA program analyst of all social media posts that it makes related to the project.

c. The Recipient will remove specific content related to the project from social media if USDA determines it to be inappropriate. If the Recipient fails to comply with a requirement of Section IV, Paragraph C.4, USDA may require that all of the Recipient's individual social media posts related to the project be pre-cleared by the appropriate USDA program analyst.

5. *Disclaimer Language*

The Recipient will include the following language in any non-pedagogical or training materials that are distributed to the public under the project:

"This [study/report/publication/audiovisual/other information or media product (specify)] was made possible by the generous support of the American people through the United States Department of Agriculture's Food for Progress Program. The contents are the responsibility of the Recipient and do not necessarily reflect the views of the United States Department of Agriculture or the United States Government."

6. *Other Communications Requirements*

a. Approval Process for Materials

The Recipient will submit the following materials to, and obtain the approval of, the appropriate USDA program analyst before using or distributing the materials:

- Templates for banners, project-site signs, presentations, and other common formats
- Templates for Press releases
- Templates for Policy Papers

The Recipient must submit such materials in the English language as part of the work plan or annual update referenced in Part III, Item II, Paragraph C, of this agreement.

b. The Recipient must update fact sheets on a regular basis, but not less frequently than once a year,

and as requested by the appropriate USDA program analyst.

c. The Recipient must submit at least one success story as an attachment to each semiannual performance report or as requested by the appropriate USDA program analyst. Multiple stories are encouraged to show a fuller picture of the success of the project. The Recipient will submit a success story(ies) that:

- Is grounded in data.
- Reflects a broader look at the success of a specific activity or the project rather than a focus on specific individuals.
- Includes a high-quality photo with corresponding caption and photo credit.

USDA is also interested in receiving human interest stories that may be shared with FAS Post and U.S. Embassy colleagues.

d. When beneficiaries will receive donated commodities directly, the Recipient will provide information to the beneficiaries regarding the proper preparation and use of such commodities.

7. *Promotional Items*

a. The Recipient will clearly outline any plans to produce promotional items related to the project in its Project Communication Plan. The Recipient will only produce such products when necessary to advance the goals of the project.

b. The Recipient will not produce or distribute any promotional item that is marked with the USDA logo until after it has demonstrated a clear connection between the item and the project's objectives, and the production and distribution of the promotional item has been approved by the appropriate USDA program analyst.

8. *Reporting on Public Outreach and Response*

The Recipient will submit to the appropriate USDA program analyst, in the semiannual performance report submitted in accordance with Part III, Item II, Paragraph F(1), of this agreement, information that quantifies the Recipient's outreach activities and response during the reporting period for the project implemented under this agreement. In each such report the Recipient will quantify the media used, the number of pieces of content per media, the exposure of each piece of content, and the total estimated exposure for the reporting period across all media platforms. The information in each report must include the following categories:

- Press Releases: Quantify number of releases, outlets picking up content, and circulation.
- Events: Quantify number of events and total attendees.
- Radio: Quantify segments and listenership.
- TV: Quantify segments and viewership.
- Web: Quantify pieces of content (e.g., articles, blogs, etc.) and webpage visits.
- Social Media: Quantify pieces of original content (not comments, likes, etc.), outlets (e.g., Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), YouTube, Instagram, etc.), and total views across media platforms.

V. Waiver of Requirements

A. In accordance with 7 CFR section 1499.8(e), the Recipient may request USDA to waive compliance with one or more of the labeling, marking, or notification requirements under this agreement. The Recipient will not have to comply with such requirement(s) while awaiting a determination by USDA regarding its waiver request if the Recipient determines that compliance with such requirement(s) poses an imminent threat of injury, loss of life, or destruction of property in the target country. In such case, the Recipient must submit to USDA an explanation of the safety or security risk, as soon as possible, in a letter on the Recipient's letterhead and signed by an authorized official within the Recipient's organization.

B. Except as provided in Section V, paragraph A, the Recipient must comply with all labeling, marking, and notification requirements under this agreement unless it has received a specific approval from USDA of a request to waive compliance with one or more of such requirements. Approval of a work plan or Project Communication Plan does not constitute an approval of a waiver.

C. Pursuant to 7 CFR section 1499.8(e)(1), the Recipient may submit a written request for a waiver at any time after the agreement has been signed. The Recipient is encouraged to submit any request to waive a marking requirement, any proposed alternatives, and detailed information to justify the waiver request before submitting the Project Communication Plan, to the extent possible. The Recipient may not incorporate in the Project Communication Plan a deviation from a marking requirement unless USDA has approved a waiver request to permit such deviation. The Recipient may request a waiver when a marking requirement would:

- Prevent an appearance of neutrality that would further the objective or purpose of the product.
- Reduce the credibility of the project's data or findings.
- Impair the functionality of the product.
- Not be cost-beneficial or practical.
- Violate cultural or social norms or otherwise be considered inappropriate.
- Violate applicable international law.
- Deter achievement of project goals.
- Detract from host country "ownership."
- Place project beneficiaries or the Recipient's staff in physical jeopardy.

Annex 1: Communications Plan – Sample Marking Plan

Product	Type & Placement of Marking	Remarks
200 Project Signs (located at each of the 200 project schools)	3ft x 2ft signboard placed at entrance of school. Signboard will include USDA logo, program name, target country's logo, project title, and name of school, and acknowledge USDA as the donor.	Ministry of Education requires that its logo be placed in the upper left corner.
Training Manuals	USDA logo, program name, Recipient's logo, and project title will be displayed on the cover of the manual.	
Project page on Recipient website	USDA logo, program name, Recipient's logo, and project title will be displayed.	Webpage information will be maintained in the French language.